



FABPROFIT FIELD GUIDE

THE YOUNG TRADESMAN'S

HARD TO REPLACE

How to become an elite welder-fabricator, earn more, and become the employee every good shop fights to keep.



A brutally practical guide to skill, speed, reliability, judgment, ownership, and reputation.

WRITTEN BY

Greg Sheldon

FabProfit System

BUILD

Elite skill

DELIVER

Correct work

EARN

More leverage

LEAD

More trust

READ THIS FIRST

THIS BOOK WILL NOT PROTECT YOUR FEELINGS.

It is designed to help you become more useful, more trusted, and harder to replace.

Being young is not an excuse. Having potential is not a result. A good weld does not automatically make you a good fabricator. Wanting more money does not automatically make you worth more money.

A NOTE FROM GREG

After more than 25 years around welding, fabrication, management, sales, and estimating, I learned that the best-paid tradesmen were not always the flashiest welders. They were the people the shop could trust with difficult work, expensive material, incomplete information, safety, quality, and the company's reputation.

THE STANDARD

Become the person who reduces risk, finishes work correctly, tells the truth early, and makes the whole crew stronger.

USE THIS GUIDE WITH REAL RULES

This is career and work-habit training. It is not a welding procedure manual. Current drawings, specifications, employer procedures, approved welding procedures, codes, safety requirements, equipment manuals, and qualified supervision always control the work. Never exceed your qualification or guess at a technical requirement because you want to look confident.

THE TEST STARTS ON YOUR NEXT SHIFT.

THE MONEY EQUATION

YOU ARE NOT PAID FOR EFFORT. YOU ARE PAID FOR USEFUL, DEPENDABLE RESULTS.

Effort matters. The shop still has to receive correct work, at a useful pace, from someone it can trust.

EARNING POWER

=

SKILL

x

RELIABILITY

x

OUTPUT

x

JUDGMENT

x

TRUST

When one factor is weak, the whole result collapses.

1

Skill without reliability

Talent nobody can schedule.

2

Speed without quality

Expensive rework wearing a fast time.

3

Knowledge without ownership

Advice that still leaves somebody else holding the job.

4

Hard work without finished results

Exhaustion, not value.

The shop does not need a hero. It needs somebody it can count on when the job is difficult and nobody is clapping.

THE VALUE LADDER

THE FIVE LEVELS OF A TRADESMAN

Your pay ceiling usually follows the level of responsibility the shop can safely give you.

1**LIABILITY**

Creates rework, safety risk, delay, drama, or constant supervision.

2**EXTRA PAIR OF HANDS**

Can complete directed tasks, but needs the path explained and checked.

3**SKILLED PRODUCER**

Produces acceptable work at a useful pace under normal conditions.

4**PROBLEM SOLVER**

Sees trouble early, asks the right question, and offers a workable next step.

5**MULTIPLIER**

Makes the crew, handoff, process, and future jobs better. Can be trusted with outcomes.

The biggest pay jump happens when you stop needing constant direction and start preventing problems before they reach the foreman.

THE UNDERPAID HABITS

12 REASONS YOUNG TRADESMEN STAY EASY TO REPLACE

These behaviours cost trust faster than a single ugly weld.

01

BARELY ON TIME

Arrives at start time, then spends ten minutes getting ready.

02

PHONE CONTROLLED

Checks the screen every time the work gets boring.

03

REPEATED INSTRUCTIONS

Makes the foreman carry the same information twice.

04

RUSHED PREP

Saves five minutes before the weld and creates an hour after it.

05

HIDDEN MISTAKES

Lets the next operation discover the problem.

06

MESS LEFT BEHIND

Transfers cleanup and risk to somebody else.

07

ONE-SKILL IDENTITY

Can run one process, but cannot fit, read, plan, or finish.

08

DRAWING AVOIDANCE

Builds from memory, hearsay, or what it probably means.

09

NOT MY JOB

Protects the task instead of helping finish the job.

10

CORRECTION RESISTANCE

Treats coaching like disrespect.

11

SWEAT AS PROOF

Confuses being tired with producing useful work.

12

DRAMA AND EXCUSES

Makes every problem heavier than it already is.

If several of these sound like you, your boss may not be the main problem.

THE FULL WORK PATH

BE A FABRICATOR, NOT JUST A PERSON WHO CAN WELD.

Arc time is only the middle. Elite tradesmen understand what has to happen before and after the weld.

1 VERIFY

Revision, material, dimensions, condition

2 LAY OUT

Datum, square, sequence, repeatability

3 CUT + PREP

Stock, kerf, edges, holes, cleanliness

4 FIT + HOLD

Gap, alignment, tacks, clamps, access

5 WELD + CONTROL

Procedure, position, heat, distortion

6 CLEAN + FINISH

Spatter, grinding, prep, protection

7 INSPECT + RECORD

Measure, identify, correct, sign off

8 MOVE + DELIVER

Stage, flip, load, protect, install

THE DIFFERENCE

A bead layer completes the weld. A fabricator understands the finished assembly, the path, the risks, and the next person who has to touch it.

Become useful across the whole path.

DRAWING DISCIPLINE

READ THE DRAWING BEFORE YOU TOUCH THE STEEL.

The drawing shows the result. Your job is to understand the path that makes the result buildable.

1 ORIENT

Confirm project, sheet, revision, issue status, units, scale, addenda, and missing information.

2 TRACE

Follow the deliverable through plans, elevations, sections, details, schedules, notes, and specifications.

3 SIMULATE

Build, handle, finish, move, ship, and install it in your head before committing material or labour.

BEFORE FABRICATION, CONFIRM:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Correct drawing and revision | ☐ Written dimensions and control points |
| ☐ Material grade, shape, wall, and thickness | ☐ Weld type, size, length, side, and finish |
| ☐ Tolerance, inspection, and documentation | ☐ Coating or surface-preparation requirements |
| ☐ Field dimensions, access, anchors, and equipment | ☐ Missing, conflicting, approximate, or field-verify notes |

Do not build from memory. Do not invent missing facts. Ask, clarify, or state a controlled basis.

FIT-UP

FIT-UP IS WHERE ELITE WELDERS SEPARATE THEMSELVES.

A beautiful weld cannot rescue bad geometry, bad access, or a part locked in the wrong position.

A BEAUTIFUL WELD CANNOT RESCUE BAD GEOMETRY.

1 CLEAN THE JOINT

Remove the condition that prevents sound fit-up or approved welding. Do not weld through avoidable contamination.

2 CONTROL GAP + ALIGNMENT

Know the accepted joint condition. Use the drawing, procedure, fit-up standard, and supervision.

3 ESTABLISH DATUM + SQUARE

Check overall geometry before small local details trap the assembly.

4 PLAN TACKS + CLAMPING

Hold what must stay true. Sequence tacks, jigs, dogs, wedges, and clamps with removal in mind.

5 PLAN ACCESS FIRST

Can the joint be reached, cleaned, welded, inspected, and repaired after the next part is installed?

6 PREDICT MOVEMENT

Heat, restraint, sequence, and repeated welds move steel. Plan the direction instead of acting surprised.

BEFORE YOU LOCK IT IN: CAN IT BE MEASURED? REACHED? MOVED? INSPECTED?

WELDING DISCIPLINE

WELD LIKE SOMEBODY WILL CUT IT APART.

Quality is preparation, approved procedure, control, and honest self-inspection. It is not confidence alone.

BEFORE THE ARC

- Confirm the approved drawing, revision, weld requirement, procedure, and your qualification.
- Verify joint preparation, fit-up, cleanliness, backing, consumables, polarity, gas, and equipment condition.
- Apply preheat, interpass control, sequence, and environmental controls when the governing requirement calls for them.
- Make sure the position is stable and the weld can be completed, cleaned, inspected, and repaired if necessary.
- Stop when the information or condition is outside your authority. Confidence does not replace approval.

DURING + AFTER

- Use stable technique and watch the puddle, joint, arc, travel, and changing position, not only the appearance behind you.
- Stop on a suspected defect. Do not bury it because the next pass will cover it.
- Control sequence and restraint so the assembly stays within the required geometry.
- Clean between operations as required. Inspect your own work before another person has to find the problem.
- Identify, document, protect, and hand off the work in a condition the next person can trust.

Do not improvise outside the approved procedure because you think you can make it work. That is ego, not skill.

Current procedures, codes, employer rules, and qualified supervision control the work.

PRODUCTIVE FLOW

FAST IS FEWER TOUCHES, NOT FASTER PANIC.

Speed comes from seeing the work, counting events, staging the job, and reducing avoidable movement.

SEARCHING

WALKING

WAITING

REHANDLING

FLIPPING

CORRECTING

RE-ASKING

1 READ FIRST

Know the priority, drawing, sequence, and quality gate before moving material.

2 STAGE ONCE

Bring the right material, tools, fixtures, and consumables to the work.

3 PROVE THE FIRST

Check the first piece before repeating the mistake twenty times.

4 BATCH REPEATS

Group the same cuts, holes, fits, welds, and checks when the job allows it.

5 REDUCE MOVES

Plan crane picks, flips, table space, carts, and load sequence before the assembly grows.

6 CLOSE THE LOOP

Clean, inspect, mark, stage, and tell the next person what is ready or held.

THE USEFUL MEASURE

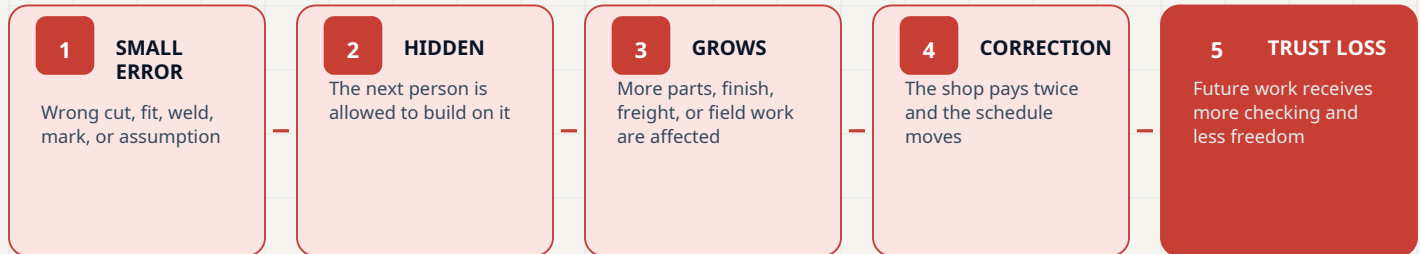
GOOD, ACCEPTED OUTPUT**TOTAL PAID TIME**

Arc time matters, but total value also includes setup, movement, control, and real-world friction.

REWORK

REWORK IS THE TAX ON BAD HABITS.

The fastest way to look busy and stay underpaid is to keep fixing your own preventable mistakes.



OWN IT AT THE SMALLEST POSSIBLE SIZE

- 01 STOP**
 Do not keep adding work to a condition you do not trust.
- 02 PROTECT**
 Mark, hold, isolate, or support the affected material and work area.
- 03 TELL**
 Inform the responsible lead early and state the facts without a story.
- 04 RECORD**
 Identify what is affected, what is not, and what changed.
- 05 CORRECT + LEARN**
 Use the approved correction, then change the habit, check, or setup that failed.

A mistake does not automatically destroy trust. Hiding it does.

SAFETY + FITNESS FOR DUTY

UNSAFE IS NOT TOUGH. IT IS EXPENSIVE.

The best tradesman goes home intact and sends everybody around him home intact.

1 HOT WORK + FIRE

Control sparks, slag, combustibles, permits, fire watch, and the area after the work stops.

2 FUMES + VENTILATION

Use required ventilation, respiratory protection, positioning, and material awareness.

3 PPE + SENSORY DAMAGE

Protect eyes, face, skin, hearing, lungs, and hands. Damage can be permanent before it feels dramatic.

4 LIFTING + RIGGING

Know capacity, balance, route, pinch points, communication, and who is authorized to direct the lift.

5 ENERGY + EQUIPMENT

Respect lockout, stored energy, rotating equipment, compressed gas, electrical condition, and guarding.

6 FIT FOR DUTY

Never report impaired. Fatigue, alcohol, drugs, or medication effects can make confidence dangerous. Speak up before somebody gets hurt.

A shortcut that can injure somebody is not initiative. It is a liability.

THE WORK AREA

YOUR WORK AREA IS YOUR RESUME.

You are judged by what the next person inherits, especially when nobody reminds you to clean it up.

WHAT AMATEURS LEAVE

- Scrap mixed with usable material
- Damaged tools hidden or returned broken
- Cables, hoses, leads, and trip hazards everywhere
- Unmarked parts and unidentified hardware
- Empty wire, gas, consumables, batteries, or bottles for the next shift
- Finished surfaces dragged, stacked, or exposed
- A station that requires ten minutes before useful work can start
- A problem everybody can see except the person who created it

WHAT PROFESSIONALS LEAVE

- Tools returned ready, clean, charged, and reported if damaged
- Material protected, remnants labeled, and scrap separated
- Parts identified, checked, staged, and easy to count
- Consumables ready for the next operation or shift
- Hazards removed, routes clear, and cables controlled
- Finished surfaces supported and protected
- Status, hold points, missing information, and defects clearly communicated
- The next useful action made obvious

The condition of your station tells the shop whether you think beyond your own hands.

COMMUNICATION

THE FOUR-SENTENCE PROFESSIONAL

Good communication does not mean talking more. It means making the decision easier and safer.

01

HERE IS WHAT I UNDERSTAND.

State the drawing, task, quantity, condition, priority, or instruction in plain language.

02

HERE IS WHAT IS MISSING OR CONFLICTING.

Name the exact dimension, note, finish, sequence, responsibility, or approval that is unclear.

03

HERE IS THE RISK IF WE CONTINUE.

Explain the likely effect on fit, quality, safety, rework, schedule, or the next operation.

04

HERE IS WHAT I RECOMMEND.

Offer the next question, hold point, check, alternate, or responsible person.

EXAMPLE

"The opening is marked field verify. The final dimension is not released. If we cut now, the frame may not fit and we could lose material and schedule. I recommend holding the final cut until the dimension is confirmed in writing."

Questions are not weakness. Vague questions and silent guessing are.

THE KILLER EMPLOYEE

THE STANDARD EVERY FOREMAN WANTS BUT RARELY GETS

The goal is not to be loud, impressive, or impossible to manage. The goal is to be trusted.

1 READY BEFORE START

Arrive early enough to be dressed, equipped, and ready when paid work begins.

2 KNOW THE PRIORITY

Confirm what matters now, what comes next, and what cannot be blocked.

3 ASK ONCE + RECORD IT

Write down dimensions, quantities, settings, changes, and decisions you will need again.

4 FINISH THE TASK

Complete the check, cleanup, identification, and handoff, not only the exciting part.

5 OWN THE MISTAKE

Tell the truth early and help contain the effect.

6 CONTROL THE PHONE

Keep your attention where the risk and money are.

7 HELP THE CREW FINISH

Do not protect your own little task while the job around you fails.

8 LEAVE THE NEXT STEP READY

Stage, mark, protect, and communicate so work can continue.

9 ACCEPT CORRECTION

Separate your ego from the requirement and improve the work.

10 CLOSE THE LOOP

Tell the lead what is complete, what is held, what changed, and what is needed next.

Make the foreman's day easier, not louder.

SHOP-FLOOR LOYALTY

DON'T BE A RAT. DON'T BE A COWARD.

Handle ordinary problems directly. Protect the crew when the stakes are real.

DO NOT RUN TO THE BOSS TO PUNISH A COWORKER OVER EVERY ANNOYANCE, HARMLESS MISTAKE, OR PERSONAL DISAGREEMENT.

RATTING + THROWING SOMEBODY UNDER THE BUS

- Reporting petty issues so you look better.
- Exaggerating a mistake or leaving out your own part.
- Spreading private business, rumors, or break-room stories.
- Recruiting people to take sides in a personal conflict.
- Using management as a weapon against somebody you dislike.
- Taking credit when it works and assigning blame when it does not.

PROTECTING THE CREW WHEN IT ACTUALLY MATTERS

- Stopping an immediate safety hazard before somebody gets hurt.
- Reporting impairment, threats, harassment, violence, or intimidation.
- Refusing to hide theft, sabotage, or deliberate falsification.
- Raising a serious quality, code, or inspection issue that could harm others.
- Escalating repeated conduct after direct, respectful attempts have failed.
- Giving the lead facts, not gossip, when the issue is outside your authority.

LOYALTY HAS A LINE

Never cover up serious danger, abuse, dishonesty, impairment, or deliberate bad work. That is not loyalty. It is handing the consequences to an innocent coworker, customer, or family.

Protect coworkers from petty betrayal. Protect the crew from real harm.

THE CREW CODE

12 WAYS TO EARN THE RESPECT OF THE CREW BESIDE YOU

Respect is not a speech. It is what people experience when they work beside you.

1 SPEAK TO HIM FIRST

For ordinary conflict, go directly and privately before going above him.

2 NEVER GOSSIP

Do not spread personal business, rumors, mistakes, or private conversations.

3 TELL THE WHOLE TRUTH

Do not throw somebody under the bus. Include your own part.

4 GIVE CREDIT

Name who helped, taught, caught the issue, or carried the load.

5 RETURN WHAT YOU BORROW

Tools, clamps, leads, chargers, consumables, and favors come back ready.

6 DO NOT STEAL

Respect another worker's tools, hours, assignments, ideas, and livelihood.

7 DO THE UGLY WORK TOO

Do not disappear when the job becomes heavy, dirty, repetitive, or miserable.

8 WARN HIM EARLY

Give a coworker a fair chance to fix an ordinary issue before it becomes public.

9 CORRECT PRIVATELY

Do not humiliate someone so the room can watch you look skilled.

10 SHARE KNOWLEDGE

Teach without hoarding tricks, settings, or information to stay important.

11 KEEP YOUR WORD

If you say you will bring it, cover it, finish it, or be there, do it.

12 DEFEND THE TRUTH

Do not join a pile-on or let a false story stand because the person is absent.

Respect is built in small moments: the borrowed tool, the ugly task, the private correction, and the truth when blame starts moving.

CONFLICT

HANDLE IT FACE TO FACE, NOT THROUGH THE BREAK ROOM.

Strong crews solve ordinary friction directly, privately, and without putting on a show.

1 COOL DOWN

Do not confront somebody while you are hot enough to threaten, insult, or perform for an audience.

2 SPEAK PRIVATELY

Use a direct opener: "I need to clear something up about what happened on this job."

3 STATE THE FACTS

Describe the action and effect. No labels, rumors, mind-reading, or character attack.

4 OWN YOUR PART

Admit what you missed, said, assumed, or could have handled better.

5 ASK FOR THE FIX

Agree what changes now, who does what, and how the next handoff will work.

6 ESCALATE CLEANLY

If it is unresolved, repeated, unsafe, threatening, abusive, dishonest, or outside your authority, involve the right lead with facts.

A DIRECT, RESPECTFUL SCRIPT

"On the rail job, the clamps were moved before the final check. I should have marked the hold point more clearly. It caused us to reset the frame. Next time, can we agree neither of us removes restraint until both dimensions are checked?"

Direct does not mean aggressive. Never threaten, corner, touch, humiliate, or intimidate a coworker. Control is strength.

Controlled men solve problems without gossip, humiliation, or threats.

REPUTATION

YOUR FOREMAN IS WATCHING THE PART YOU THINK DOES NOT COUNT.

You are always being interviewed for more trust, more difficult work, and more money.

1 THE FIRST 15 MINUTES

Are you ready and moving, or still becoming ready?

2 AFTER A CORRECTION

Do you improve, argue, sulk, or repeat the same miss?

3 AFTER LUNCH

Does your pace and attention disappear?

4 WHEN THE TASK SUCKS

Do you stay professional when the work is dirty, repetitive, awkward, or slow?

5 WHEN NOBODY IS WATCHING

Do the quality, safety, and cleanup standards remain?

6 WHEN A COWORKER STRUGGLES

Do you help the job or use the moment to look superior?

7 WHEN INFORMATION IS MISSING

Do you ask a useful question or start guessing?

8 WHEN A MISTAKE APPEARS

Do you protect the truth or protect your ego?

The promotion is often decided before the position exists.

THE HANDOFF

MAKE THE NEXT PERSON FASTER.

A messy handoff is rework before the next operation starts.

THE JOB IS NOT COMPLETE WHEN YOUR HANDS STOP. IT IS COMPLETE WHEN THE NEXT PERSON CAN CONTINUE WITHOUT GUESSING.

HANDOFF CONTROL	WHAT THE NEXT PERSON NEEDS
Drawing + revision	The exact document basis and any change or clarification used.
Quantity + identity	Piece marks, count, orientation, matched parts, hardware, and shortages.
Quality status	What was checked, what passed, what is held, and what still requires inspection.
Dimensions + fit	Critical values, field basis, trial fit, reference points, and known deviations.
Finish + protection	Surface condition, touch-up basis, cure or handling limits, and protected faces.
Hardware + tools	Kitted items, special tools, torque or installation needs, and missing components.
Status + next action	Ready, hold, change review, or complete, with the owner and required next step.
Work area	A safe, clean, staged area where useful work can begin immediately.

The best worker does not hoard knowledge to feel important. He makes the system and the people around him stronger.

VALUE LEVERS

HOW TO BECOME WORTH MORE

Higher pay becomes easier to justify when you increase useful capability and reduce the risk of giving you responsibility.

1 RARER SKILL

You can perform work fewer people can do correctly, safely, and consistently.

2 BETTER OUTPUT

You produce more accepted work with less rework, waiting, movement, and supervision.

3 LOWER RISK

You protect safety, material, quality, schedule, equipment, and the company's reputation.

4 MORE RESPONSIBILITY

You can own a larger result, coordinate others, and close the handoff without being chased.

BUILD A USEFUL SKILLS STACK**CORE WELDING**

One or more processes, positions, materials, and joint types the shop actually sells.

MATERIAL + FINISH

Identification, handling, cutting, stainless or aluminum discipline, coating, and protection.

QUALITY + RECORDS

Self-inspection, traceability, hold points, documentation, and knowing when to stop.

FITTING + LAYOUT

Measurement, geometry, drawings, tolerances, sequencing, jigs, and distortion control.

EQUIPMENT + MOVEMENT

Safe use of saws, positioners, cranes, forklifts, lifts, rigging, and material flow.

FIELD + DIGITAL + LEADERSHIP

Install, site coordination, CNC or robotics, CAD, estimating, teaching, and leading.

Do not collect random certificates. Build a combination a shop can use.

CAREER STRATEGY

PICK ONE DEEP LANE AND ONE ADJACENT LANE.

Depth makes you credible. An adjacent skill makes you flexible and harder to replace.

DEEP LANE	WHAT TO BECOME EXCELLENT AT	USEFUL ADJACENT LANE
Structural + misc. metals	Fitting, layout, connections, stairs, rails, frames, sequence, field fit	Drawings, rigging, estimating, foreman
Pipe + process work	Joint preparation, position, fit, procedure discipline, cleanliness, documentation	Layout, QA coordination, field planning
Pressure / high-spec work	Procedure compliance, traceability, quality controls, repair discipline	Inspection records, supervision, planning
Stainless + aluminum	Contamination control, distortion, finish, appearance, handling, protection	Architectural work, polishing, layout
Production + robotic	Repeatability, fixtures, first-piece proof, cycle discipline, troubleshooting	Programming, maintenance, quality data
Field + industrial install	Access, mobilization, layout, rigging, safe coordination, closeout	Leadership, planning, estimating

A SIMPLE DECISION RULE

Choose the work you want to be trusted with. Identify the three abilities that make that trust safe. Build proof one job at a time.

Pay also depends on the company, market, region, union structure, credentials, and available work.

PROOF

BUILD PROOF, NOT A SPEECH.

A raise conversation becomes easier when your value is visible, honest, and connected to work the company cares about.

Keep a private, accurate value log. Do not expose customer, pricing, drawing, or company-confidential information.

DATE / JOB	WORK COMPLETED	TIME / OUTPUT	QUALITY / REWORK	PROBLEM PREVENTED	RESPONSIBILITY ADDED

WHAT COUNTS AS PROOF

Independent work completed. New process or equipment learned. Rework avoided. First-piece success. More difficult scope. Better handoff. Useful improvement. Positive feedback. Safe leadership. Training another worker. A problem raised before it became expensive.

THE RAISE CONVERSATION

ASK FOR MORE MONEY LIKE A PROFESSIONAL.

This does not guarantee a raise. It gives you a clear, evidence-based conversation and a measurable path.

THE FOUR STEPS

1. Pick the right moment

After a solid run of performance, added responsibility, qualification, or measurable improvement. Not during a blow-up.

2. Bring evidence

Show the work you now complete, the responsibility you carry, and the results you can defend.

3. Ask for the level

State the pay or classification you are asking to discuss. Do not force your manager to guess.

4. Get the path

If the answer is not now, ask for the exact standard, review date, and proof required.

WEAK ARGUMENTS

- "I have been here a year."
- "Everything costs more now."
- "I work harder than him."
- "I am loyal."
- "I feel underpaid."
- "I deserve it."

These may be real feelings. They are weak proof of business value.

A PROFESSIONAL SCRIPT

"I want to talk about the level of work I am now handling and the value I am producing. Over the last [time period], I have added [skills or responsibilities]. I can now independently complete [work], and here are examples of quality, output, problems prevented, or handoffs I improved. I would like to discuss moving to [rate or classification]. If that is not available now, what exact results would I need to demonstrate over the next 60 to 90 days, and when will we review it?"

THE RESET

THE 30-DAY HARD-TO-REPLACE CHALLENGE

Thirty days will not make you elite. It will expose whether you are willing to live like somebody who is becoming elite.

WEEK 1 - RELIABILITY RESET

- Ready before start
- Phone controlled
- Priority confirmed
- Every task closed and reported

WEEK SCORE: ____ / 28

WEEK 2 - TECHNICAL DISCIPLINE

- Drawing and revision checked
- First piece proved
- Procedure and fit-up basis confirmed
- One mistake or near miss studied

WEEK SCORE: ____ / 28

WEEK 3 - PRODUCTIVE FLOW

- Tools and material staged
- Moves and flips planned
- Repeat work batched
- Work area reset before leaving

WEEK SCORE: ____ / 28

WEEK 4 - OWNERSHIP + LEADERSHIP

- Raise one risk early
- Improve one handoff
- Help one coworker without drama
- Ask for direct feedback

WEEK SCORE: ____ / 28

No speeches. No new identity. Thirty days of visible behaviour.

PRINTABLE

DAILY TRADESMAN SCORECARD

Score the behaviour, not the intention. One point for yes. Zero for no.

DATE _____

JOB / ASSEMBLY _____

#	CONTROL	TODAY'S STANDARD	YES	NO
1	READY	I was dressed, equipped, and ready when paid work began.		
2	FIT FOR DUTY	I worked safely, focused, and unimpaired.		
3	BASIS CONFIRMED	I checked the correct drawing, revision, procedure, and instruction before work.		
4	FIRST PIECE	I proved the first piece, setup, or critical condition before repeating it.		
5	USEFUL PACE	I reduced searching, waiting, rehandling, and avoidable movement.		
6	QUALITY	I inspected my work and raised defects or uncertainty immediately.		
7	PHONE CONTROL	My phone did not control my attention during work.		
8	WORK AREA	I left tools, material, equipment, and the area ready and safe.		
9	HANDOFF	I communicated what was complete, held, changed, or needed next.		
10	LEARNING	I recorded one lesson, correction, standard, or skill to improve.		

TOTAL SCORE

____ / 10

BIGGEST WIN _____

BIGGEST MISS _____

TOMORROW'S CORRECTION _____

PRINTABLE

MY 90-DAY SKILL PLAN

Choose one technical skill, one productivity skill, and one responsibility skill. Build proof, not vague ambition.

TECHNICAL SKILL

What do I need to perform more correctly or independently?

PRODUCTIVITY SKILL

What setup, sequence, movement, or repeat-work ability will improve useful output?

RESPONSIBILITY SKILL

What larger result can I learn to own, communicate, or hand off?

MILESTONE	WHAT I WILL DO	WHO WILL COACH / CHECK	PROOF I WILL PRODUCE	DATE
DAY 1-30				
DAY 31-60				
DAY 61-90				

REVIEW DATE

MANAGER / MENTOR

THE JOB OR TASK THAT WILL PROVE THIS PLAN

BRUTAL SELF-AUDIT

ARE YOU ACTUALLY HARD TO REPLACE?

Mark yes only when the behaviour is consistent and other people would agree.

☐ ☐ I am ready when the shift starts, not arriving.
Y N

☐ ☐ I make the next person faster through a good handoff.
Y N

☐ ☐ I rarely need the same instruction twice.
Y N

☐ ☐ I tell the lead what is complete, held, changed, or missing.
Y N

☐ ☐ I confirm the drawing and revision before fabrication.
Y N

☐ ☐ I help finish the job, not only my assigned little task.
Y N

☐ ☐ I can explain the complete work path, not only my weld.
Y N

☐ ☐ I stay professional when the work is repetitive or unpleasant.
Y N

☐ ☐ I can fit and control geometry, not only deposit metal.
Y N

☐ ☐ I can be trusted when nobody is watching.
Y N

☐ ☐ I ask before guessing at missing information.
Y N

☐ ☐ I can identify a problem and recommend a next step.
Y N

☐ ☐ I know the limits of my qualification and authority.
Y N

☐ ☐ I have added a useful skill in the last 90 days.
Y N

☐ ☐ I report mistakes and suspect defects immediately.
Y N

☐ ☐ I can show evidence of quality, output, or responsibility growth.
Y N

☐ ☐ I accept correction without excuses or attitude.
Y N

☐ ☐ I protect safety even when schedule pressure is high.
Y N

☐ ☐ I can work at a useful pace without sacrificing quality.
Y N

☐ ☐ I can teach a basic task without making the learner feel stupid.
Y N

☐ ☐ I control my phone and attention.
Y N

☐ ☐ I know what my work costs when it must be redone.
Y N

☐ ☐ I keep tools, material, and equipment ready and protected.
Y N

☐ ☐ My foreman would choose me for a difficult job.
Y N

☐ ☐ I leave a clean, safe, usable work area.
Y N

22-25

Hard to replace

17-21

Valuable but inconsistent

11-16

Skilled but risky

0-10

Easy to replace

SIGN IT IF YOU MEAN IT

THE TRADESMAN'S CODE

A standard is real only when it controls behaviour under pressure.

1

I will not ask to be paid like a professional while behaving like a helper.

2

I will be ready when the work starts.

3

I will read before I cut, ask before I guess, and verify before I repeat.

4

I will respect approved procedures, safety rules, material, tools, equipment, and other people's time.

5

I will not hide a mistake, defect, delay, or missing condition.

6

I will build the whole job in my head, not only the part I enjoy.

7

I will treat fit-up, movement, cleaning, inspection, and handoff as real work.

8

I will control my phone, attitude, excuses, and ego.

9

I will make the next person faster, safer, and more certain.

10

I will add a useful skill before I demand a higher ceiling.

11

I will help the crew finish without sacrificing the standard.

12

I will leave every job, tool, area, and teammate better than I found them.

SIGNATURE

DATE



FABPROFIT FIELD GUIDE

YOUR NEXT SHIFT IS THE TEST.

BECOME THE MAN THE SHOP CAN BUILD AROUND.

Skill gets you in. Reliability keeps you in. Judgment moves you up. Ownership makes you hard to replace.

THE STANDARD

Correct work. Useful pace. Safe judgment. Early truth. Clean handoff.
Constant improvement.

Greg Sheldon

FabProfit System | Metal Fabrication Nation

Educational field guide. Use current employer procedures, drawings, approved welding procedures, codes, and safety rules.